

SWETHA MATHIYALAGAN

Strategic Design | User Experience | Product & Service Innovation

Strategic Designer with an M.Des from NID, bringing together user research, business understanding and systems thinking to shape products, services and experiences.

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Nolwa Studio (04/2026- Present)

Strategy & Design Research - Consultant

- Conducted client profiling and market research to understand target segments, **user preferences, collector behaviours and market trends**, informing customer segmentation and product positioning.
- **Researched client acquisition channels and stakeholder journeys** to identify engagement opportunities and develop targeted outreach strategies for collectors, art advisors, curators, galleries and institutions.
- Engaged with stakeholders to **understand user behaviour, expectations and market gaps**, translating insights into business development opportunities.
- Managed applications for international exhibitions and design platforms, including PAD London, Dubai Art Week and India Art Fair, alongside gallery engagement and institutional outreach.

Life in Frame Studio (04/2025- Present)

Experience Design & Research

- **WedLink | Zero-to-One Product Development**
  - **Conceptualised, prototyped and tested a digital hiring platform addressing talent discovery, payment reliability and coordination challenges within India's informal wedding industry.**
- Mapped multi-stakeholder ecosystem (clients, planners, vendors, logistics partners).
- Conducted 30+ stakeholder interviews and service journey audits to identify gaps in talent discovery, payment reliability and vendor coordination
- **Translated research insights into product opportunities, defining a trust-led platform architecture**
- Designed and prototyped key product mechanisms, including crew verification, milestone-based escrow payments, neutral dispute resolution and standardised work contracts.
- Tested the prototype with early users, gathering feedback to evaluate the proposed experience and inform subsequent iterations.

Design Strategy

- **Repositioned Life in Frame Photography into LIF Studio:**
  - A premium experiential design studio for the South Indian market. **Defined target segments, value-based pricing and an end-to-end service delivery model.**
- **Launched a luxury decor vertical, building and leading a four-member cross-functional team** across design, procurement, vendor operations and logistics.
- Standardised operational workflows, reducing operating expenses by 33%.
- **Outcome: Delivered seven high-value projects and generated ₹44 lakh in revenue within six months.**

WORK EXPERIENCE

Eat Drink and Party (*03/2024- 03/2025)*

Service Design

- Mapped vendor ecosystems, customer journeys and event execution workflows to identify operational bottlenecks.
- **Developed service blueprints and standardised workflows** to improve onboarding, coordination and delivery.
- **Translated tacit operational knowledge into repeatable systems** and documentation.
- Led on-ground implementation across 10+ large-scale events.
- **Outcome: Improved production cost efficiency by 2× and enhanced scalability during high-demand periods.**

Shell (*09/2023-02/2024)*

User Research and Interface (Internship)

- **Research & Service Design Hub (Shell's RSH) | Zero-to-One Product Development:**
  - **Conceived and prototyped a scalable, tailor-made research repository for Shell's EXD team.**
- Designed to systematise research knowledge within Shell's Experience Design team, improving access to past learnings and cross-functional visibility of design capabilities.
- **Conducted in-depth qualitative interviews with seasoned service designers & User researchers within Shell's Experience Design team (EXD)**
- Synthesized findings into actionable recommendations for senior stakeholders, translating findings into structured documentation and governance recommendations.
- **Outcome: Conducted usability testing to evaluate the prototype and inform potential integration with Shell's design system.**

EDUCATION

M.Des - Strategic Design Management
National Institute of Design (2021-2025)

- Studied design thinking and strategic planning in the context of business and organisational challenges.
- Explored market research and user analysis to identify opportunities for design innovation.
- Developed an understanding of service and systems thinking to analyse complex, interconnected challenges.

B.Arch - Architecture
Anna University, MSOA (2016-2021)

INDUSTRY- ACADEMIA PROJECTS

Organisational Design - eSec Security consultants

- Analysed the existing business environment, identified improvement opportunities and developed a strategic roadmap for future growth.

SKILLS

- User Research & User Experience Design
- Project & Stakeholder Management
- Digital innovation strategy
- Service design
- Prototyping, Usability testing

TOOLS

- Figma | Miro | Canva | Adobe Photoshop | Lovable | Cursor